

Johnny Chace, the Face

Character Name

Human

Ancestry

Aristocrat

Career

Troubadour

Class

Auteur

Subclass (Class Act)

VICTORIES:

LEVEL

3

WEALTH

1

RENOWN

1

XP

32

MIGHT

0

AGILITY

2

REASON

0

INTUITION

1

PRESENCE

2

1M

Size

7

Speed

2

Disengage

0

Stability

STAMINA



Current

Winded
≤ 16

Dying
0 to -16

33

Temporary

Max

RECOVERIES



11

Stamina

10

Max

HEROIC
RESOURCE



Drama

Name

SURGES



1 Surge = Damage +2
2 Surges = Potency + 1

EQUIPMENT AND MODIFIERS

◆ Kit

Cloak and Dagger

Kit

Light Weapon

Weapon / Implement

Light Armor

Armor / Ward

+2

Speed

+1

Disengage

+3

Stamina

0

Stability

0

Melee Dist.

+5

Ranged Dist.

Melee Damage Bonus

+1

≤11

+1

12-16

+1

17+

Ranged Damage Bonus

+1

≤11

+1

12-16

+1

17+

EFFECTS

✖ Fade

Main Action

A stab, and a few quick, careful steps back.

CONDITIONS

Condition	End of Turn	Save Ends*
Bleeding	◇	◇
Dazed	◇	◇
Frightened	◇	◇
Grabbed	◇	◇
Prone	◇	◇
Restrained	◇	◇
Slowed	◇	◇
Taunted	◇	◇
Weakened	◇	◇
	◇	◇
	◇	◇

* Save Ends = 6 or higher on 1d10 at the end of your turn removes the effect.

Immunities

None

Weaknesses

None

CLASS FEATURES

Missed Cue

If you aren't surprised at the start of an encounter, you can choose one enemy within your line of effect who is not a leader or solo creature. The Director temporarily removes the chosen creature from the encounter. The chosen creature enters the encounter at the start of the second combat round. You must earn 3 Victories before you can use this feature again.

Routines

You enter every battle with a set of performance abilities at the ready. Performances are magical presentations (such as songs, dances, poems, or gymnastic feats) that your allies can participate in. These abilities have the Performance keyword. At the start of each combat round, as long as you are not dazed, dead, or surprised, you can either choose a new performance or maintain your current performance (no action required). Your performance lasts until you are unable to maintain it or until the end of the encounter.

Scene Partner

Whenever you obtain a success on a test to interact with an NPC using a skill from the interpersonal group, you can form a bond with that NPC. When you enter into a negotiation with a bonded NPC, their patience increases by 1 (to a maximum of 5). Additionally, the first time during a negotiation that you personally make an argument that would increase a bonded NPC's interest by 1, you instead increase their interest by 2 (to a maximum of 5).

...(continued in reference)...

My Reputation Precedes Me

You can invoke your reputation at the start of a social interaction with one or more NPCs who haven't met you before, automatically creating a bond with one of those NPCs from that group as if using your Scene Partner feature. This bond counts against the limit on active bonds from your Scene Partner feature. While the bond is active, all heroes present treat their Renown as 2 higher than usual for the purpose of entering into a negotiation with the bonded NPC.

...(continued in reference)...

Remaining features in Reference...

POTENCY

WEAK

0

AVERAGE

1

STRONG

2

GAINING DRAMA

Gain When

- 1d3 Start of your turn
- 10 When you or another hero dies
- 3 Whenever a creature within your line of effect rolls a natural 19 or 20
- 2 The first time any hero is made winded during the encounter
- 2 The first time three or more heroes use an ability on the same turn

SPENDING HERO TOKENS

1 Token: Gain 2 Surges.

1 Token: Succeed on a saving throw instead of failing.

1 Token: Reroll a test and use the new result.

2 Tokens: On your turn or when you take damage, regain Stamina equal to your recovery value without spending a Recovery before taking the damage.

YOUR TURN

Each creature can take a move action, a maneuver, and a main action on their turn — in any order

You can also take **one triggered action per round** when the trigger happens. There is no limit to the number of free triggered actions you can take.

CULTURE

CULTURE NAME

Human

CULTURE LANGUAGE

• 1 Language Vaslorian

You gain an edge on tests made to recall lore about your culture, and on tests made to influence and interact with people of your culture.

LANGUAGES

- Caelian
- Szetch
- Vaslorian

ENVIRONMENT

Urban

ORGANIZATION

Communal

UPBRINGING

Labor

• 1 Interpersonal or Intrigue Skill

Gamble

• 1 Crafting or Exploration Skill

Forgery

• 1 Exploration Skill

Navigate

CAREER

Aristocrat

BENEFIT

- **Renown: +1 Renown**
- **Wealth: +1 Wealth**
- **1 Language** Szetch
- **1 Lore Perk** But I Know Who Does
- **1 Interpersonal Skill** Flirt
- **1 Lore Skill** Culture

INCITING INCIDENT

Privileged Position

Life outside the manor never piqued your interest. You had everything you wanted. It came as a surprise when the peasants came to overthrow your family. You narrowly escaped, and for the first time witnessed the world. It caused you to become a hero for the people, fighting against inequities.

COMPLICATION

I Don't Know These People

DESCRIPTION

Even while you're fighting for your life, you give the impression of being a harmless bystander. When a creature who has **I < 1** targets you with a damage-dealing ability with a single target, the ability instead targets one of your allies of the creature's choice, provided one is in range.

SKILLS

Have 1+ skills that apply to a test? +2 bonus

CRAFTING

- | | |
|-----------------|-------------|
| ◇ Alchemy | ◇ Fletching |
| ◇ Architecture | ◆ Forgery |
| ◇ Blacksmithing | ◇ Jewelry |
| ◇ Carpentry | ◇ Mechanics |
| ◇ Cooking | ◇ Tailoring |

EXPLORATION

- | | |
|--------------|------------|
| ◇ Climb | ◇ Jump |
| ◇ Drive | ◇ Lift |
| ◇ Endurance | ◆ Navigate |
| ◇ Gymnastics | ◇ Ride |
| ◇ Heal | ◇ Swim |

INTERPERSONAL

- | | |
|------------------|---------------|
| ◆ Brag | ◇ Lead |
| ◇ Empathize | ◆ Lie |
| ◆ Flirt | ◇ Music |
| ◆ Gamble | ◇ Perform |
| ◇ Handle Animals | ◆ Persuade |
| ◇ Interrogate | ◆ Read Person |
| ◇ Intimidate | |

INTRIGUE

- | | |
|------------------|---------------|
| ◇ Alertness | ◇ Pick Lock |
| ◇ Conceal Object | ◆ Pick Pocket |
| ◇ Disguise | ◇ Sabotage |
| ◇ Eavesdrop | ◇ Search |
| ◇ Escape Artist | ◇ Sneak |
| ◇ Hide | ◇ Track |

LORE

- | | |
|-----------------|-------------|
| ◇ Criminal Und. | ◇ Psionics |
| ◆ Culture | ◇ Religion |
| ◇ History | ◇ Rumors |
| ◇ Magic | ◇ Society |
| ◇ Monsters | ◇ Strategy |
| ◇ Nature | ◇ Timescape |

ANCESTRY TRAITS AND PERKS

Can't Take Hold

Your connection to the natural world allows you to resist certain supernatural effects. You ignore temporary difficult terrain created by magic and psionic abilities. Additionally, when you are force moved by a magic or psionic ability, you can reduce the forced movement distance by 1.

But I Know Who Does

Whenever you fail a test to recall lore using a skill from the lore skill group, you instinctively recall the nearest location where the information you seek might be found. This could be the tower of a local sage, a library in a nearby city, somewhere deep in a dungeon, or any other location of the Director's determination. The Director can decide that certain lore can't be revealed this way.

Engrossing Monologue

Whenever you are not in combat, you can shout to get the attention of hearing creatures within 10 squares of you. Each such creature who is not hostile toward you listens to what you have to say for 1 uninterrupted minute or more, or until they sense danger or any form of imminent harm. While creatures are listening to you, each of your allies gains an edge on tests made to avoid being noticed by those creatures.

★ Detect the Supernatural

Maneuver

You open your awareness to detect supernatural creatures and phenomena.

- **Staying Power: +2 Recoveries**

SIGNATURE ABILITY

WITTY BANTER

A lyrical (and physical) jab insults an enemy and inspires an ally.

Magic, Melee, Ranged, Strike **Main Action**
 ⚔️ Melee 1, Ranged 5 ⚙️ One creature

Power Roll + 2

⚔️11 6 psychic damage

⚔️12-16 7 psychic damage

⚔️17+ 9 psychic damage

Effect:

One ally within 10 squares of you can end one effect on them that is ended by a saving throw or that ends at the end of their turn.

Spend 1:

The chosen ally can spend a Recovery.

SIGNATURE ABILITY

YOU WERE WATCHING THE WRONG ONE

They can't watch both of you at once.

Melee, Strike, Weapon **Main Action**
 ⚔️ Melee 1 ⚙️ One creature

Power Roll + 2

⚔️11 6 damage

⚔️12-16 8 damage

⚔️17+ 11 damage

Effect:

As long as you have one or more allies within 5 squares of the target, you gain 1 surge. If you are flanking the target when you use this ability, choose one ally who is flanking with you. That ally also gains 1 surge.

SIGNATURE ABILITY

FADE

A stab, and a few quick, careful steps back.

Melee, Ranged, Strike, Weapon **Main Action**
 ⚔️ Melee 1, Ranged 10 ⚙️ One creature

Power Roll + 2

⚔️11 5 damage; you shift 1 square

⚔️12-16 8 damage; you shift up to 2 squares

⚔️17+ 10 damage; you shift up to 3 squares

HEROIC ABILITY

HYPNOTIC OVERTONES

3
COST

You produce an entrancing note that twists the senses in a spectacular fashion.

Area, Magic **Main Action**
 ⚔️ 2 Burst ⚙️ Each enemy in the area

Power Roll + 2

⚔️11 Slide 1; ⚔️1<0 dazed (save ends)

⚔️12-16 Slide 1; ⚔️1<1 dazed (save ends)

⚔️17+ Slide 2; ⚔️1<2 dazed (save ends)

Spend 2+:

The size of the burst increases by 1 for every 2 drama spent.

HEROIC ABILITY

DRAMATIC REVERSAL

5
COST

Give the audience a surprise.

Area, Magic **Main Action**
 ⚔️ 3 Burst ⚙️ Self and each ally in the area

Power Roll + 2

⚔️11 The target can shift 1 square and make a free strike.

⚔️12-16 The target can shift up to 2 squares and make a free strike that gains an edge.

⚔️17+ The target can shift up to 3 squares and make a free strike that gains an edge, then can spend a Recovery.

HEROIC ABILITY

TWIST AT THE END

5
COST

You didn't see that coming, did you?!

Magic, Ranged **Main Action**
 ⚔️ Ranged 10 ⚙️ One dead enemy

Effect:

A target who is not a leader or solo creature comes back to life with half their Stamina and becomes an ally under the Director's control. The players can work with the Director to determine when the target takes their turn each combat round. At the end of the encounter, the target turns to dust and is blown away.

MANEUVER

DRAMATIC MONOLOGUE

It doesn't need to make sense. Just say it with emotion.

Magic, Ranged **Maneuver**
 ⚔️ Ranged 10 ⚙️ Special

Effect:

Choose one of the following effects:

- You orate a rousing tale of victory. One ally within distance gains an edge on the next power roll they make before the start of your next turn.
- You weave a tale of high-stakes heroics. One ally within distance gains 1 surge.
- You insult a foe where they're most vulnerable. One enemy within distance takes a bane on the next power roll they make before the end of their next turn.

Spend 1:

You can choose two targets for the chosen effect.

MANEUVER

DETECT THE SUPERNATURAL

You open your awareness to detect supernatural creatures and phenomena.

Maneuver

Until the end of your next turn, you know the location of any supernatural object, undead, construct, or creature from another world within 5 squares, even if you don't have line of effect to that object or creature. You know if you're detecting an item or a creature, and you know the nature of any creature you detect.

HEROIC ABILITY

WE MEET AT LAST

7
COST

You magically intertwine your fate with another creature—for better or worse.

Magic, Ranged **Maneuver**
 ⚔️ Ranged 10 ⚙️ One creature

Effect:

Until the end of the encounter, both you and the target can target each other with abilities even if you are beyond distance, with the distance of this ability replacing those abilities' distances. The target can't be force moved by an ability used beyond distance this way.

Additionally, once on each of your turns, you can use a free maneuver to communicate a motivating or dispiriting message to the target, either granting them 2 surges or forcing them to take a bane on the next ability roll they make before the start of your next turn.

TRIGGERED ACTION

TURNABOUT IS FAIR PLAY

All's fair in love and whatever.

Ranged **Triggered Action**
 ⚔️ Ranged 10 ⚙️ One creature

Trigger: The target makes an ability roll that has an edge, a double edge, a bane, or a double bane.

Effect:

An edge on the triggering roll becomes a bane, or a double edge becomes an edge. A bane becomes an edge, or a double bane becomes a bane.

Spend 3:

An edge on the triggering roll becomes a double bane, or a double edge is negated. A bane becomes a double edge, or a double bane is negated.

FREE STRIKE

MELEE FREE STRIKE

Charge, Melee, Strike, Weapon **Free Strike**
 ⚔️ Melee 1 ⚙️ One creature or object

Power Roll + 2

⚔️11 5 damage

⚔️12-16 8 damage

⚔️17+ 10 damage

FREE STRIKE

RANGED FREE STRIKE

Ranged, Strike, Weapon

Free Strike

▮ Ranged 10

🎯 One creature or object

Power Roll + 2

≤11 5 damage

12-16 7 damage

17+ 9 damage

PERFORMANCE

BLOCKING

No, no, no, you lose the audience that way. Try it like this ...

Area, Magic, Performance

No Action

▮ Aura 2

🎯 Each creature in the area

Effect:

At the end of each of your turns while this performance is active, you can choose up to a number of targets equal to your Presence score and teleport those targets to unoccupied spaces in the area. A target can't be teleported in a way that would harm them (such as over a cliff), leave them dying, or result in them suffering a condition or other negative effect.

PERFORMANCE

REVITALIZING LIMERICK

There once was a man from Capital ...

Area, Magic, Performance

No Action

▮ Aura 5

🎯 Self and each ally in the area

Effect:

At the end of each of your turns while this performance is active, you can choose up to a number of targets equal to your Presence score. Each chosen target can spend a Recovery.

PERFORMANCE

CHOREOGRAPHY

Taps, kicks, steps. It's all "choreography."

Area, Magic, Performance

No Action

▮ Aura 5

🎯 Self and each ally in the area

Effect:

While this performance is active, each target who starts their turn in the area gains a +2 bonus to speed until the end of their turn.

NOTES

PROJECTS

LEARN FROM A MASTER

Item Prerequisite:



Project Source: An NPC of a higher level, or records of such an NPC's teachings in a language you know



Project Roll Characteristic: Any

Project Goal: 0

CRITICAL HIT

Whenever you make an ability roll as a main action and the roll is a natural 19 or natural 20 — a total of 19 or 20 before adding your characteristic score or other modifiers — you score a critical hit. A critical hit allows you to immediately take an additional main action after resolving the power roll, whether or not it's your turn and even if you are dazed (see Conditions below).

You can't score a critical hit with an ability roll made as a maneuver or any other action type, but you can score a critical hit with a main action you use off your turn. For example, an opportunity attack made as a triggered action or a signature ability used as a free triggered action with the assistance of the tactician's Strike Now ability can be critical hits.

ROLL VS MULTIPLE CREATURES

When an ability has multiple targets (whether a strike with more than one target or an area affect), you make one power roll and apply the total to all targets. If you have edges or banes (see Chapter 1: The Basics) against some but not all of your targets, you might apply a different tier outcome to individual targets.

For example, if you target three creatures with a strike ability and the power roll totals 11, each of the targets should be affected by the tier 1 outcome of the ability. However, if you gain an edge on strikes against one of the targets to add 2 to the power roll, your total against that target is 13, and they are affected by the tier 2 outcome of the ability.

SHIFTING

Shifting is a careful form of movement that allows a creature to move safely past dangerous foes. Certain abilities, features, and other rules allow you to shift a specific number of squares, sometimes up to your speed. Whenever you shift, creatures can't make opportunity attacks against you triggered by that movement.

You can't shift into or while within difficult terrain or damaging terrain. If a rule allows you to shift, you can choose to instead move up to the number of squares you would have shifted (for example, to get out of difficult terrain). However, you can't combine moving and shifting within that movement.

11
[illegible]

TROUBADOUR

Scene Partner

Whenever you obtain a success on a test to interact with an NPC using a skill from the interpersonal group, you can form a bond with that NPC. When you enter into a negotiation with a bonded NPC, their patience increases by 1 (to a maximum of 5). Additionally, the first time during a negotiation that you personally make an argument that would increase a bonded NPC’s interest by 1, you instead increase their interest by 2 (to a maximum of 5).

You can have a number of bonds active equal to your level. When you form a bond with a new NPC that would exceed the limit, you must choose which of your active bonds to lose.

My Reputation Precedes Me

You can invoke your reputation at the start of a social interaction with one or more NPCs who haven’t met you before, automatically creating a bond with one of those NPCs from that group as if using your Scene Partner feature. This bond counts against the limit on active bonds from your Scene Partner feature. While the bond is active, all heroes present treat their Renown as 2 higher than usual for the purpose of entering into a negotiation with the bonded NPC.

The Director can award the heroes 1 hero token to make you infamous among the group of creatures instead, and preventing you from forming this bond. Until you take action to improve your reputation, all heroes present take a bane on tests made to interact with creatures in the group using skills from the interpersonal skill group. You can still use your Scene Partner feature to find allies within the group.

Appeal to the Muses

You can give a rousing speech, invoke your inspirations, or lift your fellows’ spirits, appealing to the muses to heighten a battle’s drama. However, irony is eager to hand your fortune to the villain to achieve the same end.

Before you roll to gain drama at the start of your turn, you can make your appeal (no action required). If you do, your roll gains the following additional effects:

- If the roll is a 1, you gain 1 additional drama. The Director gains 1d3 Malice.
- If the roll is a 2, you gain 1 Heroic Resource, which you can keep or give to an ally within the distance of your active performance. The Director gains 1 Malice.
- If the roll is a 3, you gain 2 of a Heroic Resource, which you can distribute among yourself and any allies within the distance of your active performance.

Choreography

Taps, kicks, steps. It’s all “choreography.”

Revitalizing Limerick

There once was a man from Capital ...

Heroic Resource: Drama

When you are dead, you continue to gain drama during combat as long as your body is intact. If you have 30 drama during the encounter in which you died, you can come back to life with 1 Stamina and 0 drama (no action required). If you are still dead after the encounter in which you died, you can’t gain drama during future encounters.

Kit: You can use a Kit

Signature Class Ability: Witty Banter

3 Cost Class Ability: Hypnotic Overtones

5 Cost Class Ability: Dramatic Reversal

7 Cost Class Ability: We Meet at Last

Stamina: +30 Stamina

Recoveries: +8 Recoveries

1 Invocation My Reputation Precedes Me

1 Interpersonal, Lore or Supernatural Perk Engrossing Monologue

1 Skill Read Person

2 Interpersonal Skills Lie Persuade

1 Intrigue or Lore Skill Pick Pocket

AUTEUR

Turnabout Is Fair Play

All’s fair in love and whatever.

Twist at the End

You didn’t see that coming, did you?!

Blocking

No, no, no, you lose the audience that way. Try it like this ...

Dramatic Monologue

It doesn’t need to make sense. Just say it with emotion.

1 2nd-Level Class Act Ability Twist at the End

1 Skill Brag

Performance

Performance

Triggered Action

Main Action

Performance

Maneuver

MANEUVERS

Any creature can take the following maneuvers, in addition to those listed in their stats:

- **Aid Attack:** Choose an adjacent enemy. The next ability power roll an ally makes against them before the start of your next turn has an edge.
- **Catch Breath:** Spend a Recovery.
- **Claw Dirt:** You use the Claw Dirt ability.
- **Escape Grab:** You use the Escape Grab ability while grabbed.
- **Grab:** You use the Grab ability.
- **Hide:** You become hidden from creatures who aren’t observing you while you have cover or concealment from them.
- **Knockback:** You use the Knockback ability.
- **Make or Assist a Test:** Making or assisting a test is a maneuver in combat.
- **Search for Hidden Creatures:** Attempt to locate creatures hidden from you.
- **Stand Up:** You stand up from prone, ending that condition. Alternatively, you can use this maneuver to make an adjacent prone creature stand up.
- **Use Consumable:** Unless otherwise noted in its description, you can use this maneuver to activate a consumable treasure. A creature can use this maneuver to administer a consumable treasure that benefits the user either to herself or a willing adjacent creature.

MOVEMENT

All squares adjacent to your character cost 1 movement to move into. No, there’s no Pythagorean theorem on the grid. It’s a game, don’t overthink it.

Your hero can move freely through an ally’s space. You can move through an enemy’s space, but that space is difficult terrain. You can’t stop moving in any other creature’s space, including to make a strike or use a main action or maneuver while in that space and then continuing your move, unless that creature’s size is two or more sizes greater or smaller than your own.

At the Director’s discretion, you can be forced into the same space as another creature whose size is within 1 of yours, such as by falling down a narrow shaft with such a creature already at the bottom. When you are squeezed into the same space as another creature whose size is within 1 of yours, your ability rolls and tests take a bane.

Can’t Exceed Speed: A single move or other effect can never allow a creature to move more squares than their speed, unless the effect states otherwise. For example, a creature with speed 5 might have that speed reduced to 2 by the slowed condition (see Conditions in Chapter 5: Classes). If an ally then targets them with an effect that allows them to move up to 3 squares, the creature can move only 2 squares because that’s their current speed.

Can’t Cut Corners: A creature can’t move diagonally when doing so would involve passing through the corner of a wall or some other object that completely fills the corner between the creature’s space and the space they are moving to. This rule applies only to moving past objects, not moving past other creatures.